and executes them just as in a case of the command line interface. Shell here acts as both a command line interface and a scripting language interpreter to the system.

Shell scripting

Most often, we need to run specific commands multiple times to perform certain tasks. You can here use shell scripts or shell programs to ease the burden. You can create a file with particular commands and save them in a local directory of the shell. Each of these shell scripts has .sh file extension and can be called on anytime to get the desired result.

You can write shell script syntax just as you do in a programming language. Some of the primary reasons and benefits of using shell scripts include:

- Helps in automation
- Avoiding repetition of work
- Comprehensive system monitoring
- Adding new specific functionality to the shell
- Maintaining routine backups for system

Writing a script

A shell script is just like any text file to write programs or commands. So the first thing you must have is a text editor for writing. Some of the best editors include vim, gedit, kate, etc. These text editors must have syntax highlighting that differentiates colour-coded views for the elements inside the script. This syntax highlighting is also useful in avoiding common errors and semantic writing.

Here is a list of most common text editors with their interface.

NAME	DESCRIPTION	INTERFACE
vi, vim	One of the most used text editor vi is quite lightweight, fast and gives effective results. Though marred with non-intuitive command structure and complexities. vi text editors are universally available on all UNIX-like systems. A new and improved version of traditional VI, 'vim' is now gaining attention.	command line
Emacs	Developed by Richard Stallman, Emac is one of the most powerful text editors with numerous features.	command line
nano	Especially for first-time users in the command line, nano is the most accessible text editor with limited features.	command line